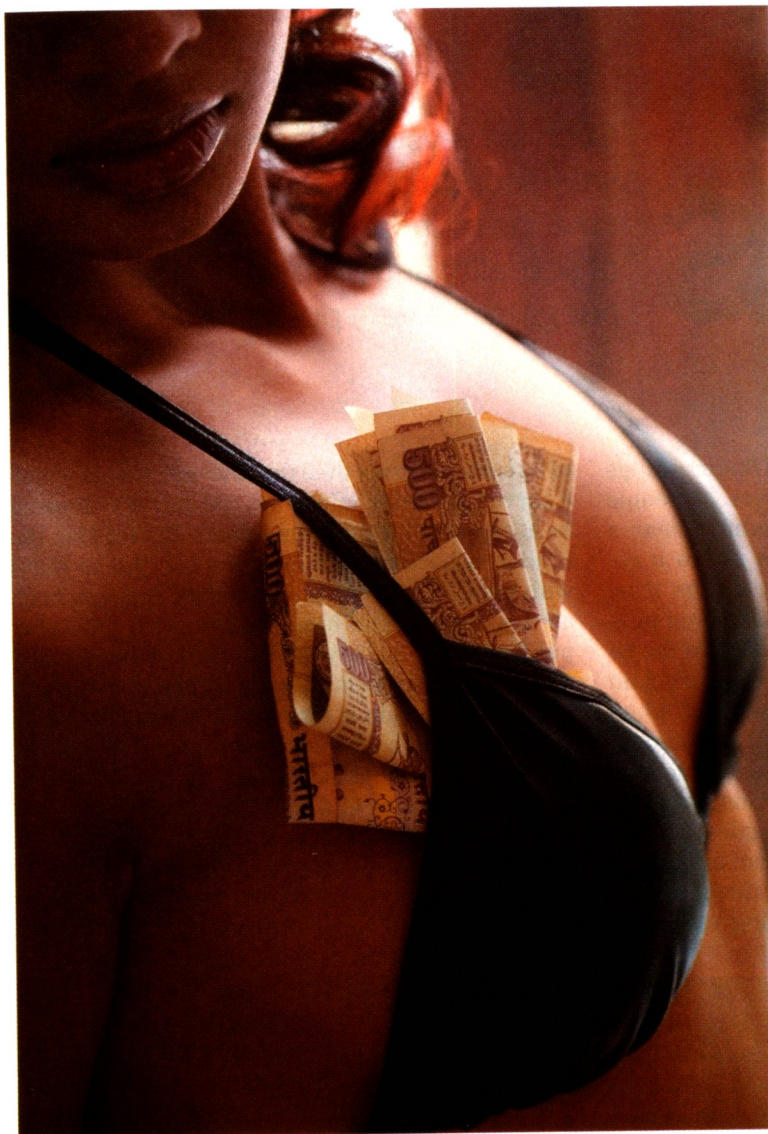




Have you ever had sex with a prostitute?

YES 10 NO **90**

Male 19, Female 2

Male 81, Female 98

Of the women who have had paid for sex, 62 per cent in Bangalore said that they have done it with a foreign prostitute at least once.

Have you ever had a homosexual experience?

YES 11 NO **89**

Male 16, Female 6

Male 84, Female 94

All figures in per cent.

Seventy-four respondents in Ludhiana have shared a homosexual experience with their friends. Jaipur follows next at 62 per cent.

WINDS OF CHANGE

28

PER CENT SAY THEY HAVE HAD SEX BEFORE THE AGE OF 20. OF THESE, 6 PER CENT HAD SEX BEFORE THEIR TEENS, CLEARLY INDICATING CHILD ABUSE.

or more of repression, of aspirations outstripping actuality. According to our survey, 27 per cent of all the respondents had never had sex, and the percentage was expectedly higher for women (35 per cent) than for men (18 per cent).

Does the survey show urban Indians speaking the language of love or of sheer desire, bottled for so many years by a socialist mentality? The fact that they are willing to even speak about their intimate lives is interesting as is the emerging female sexual self, who watches pornography as an extension of foreplay, who is testing the limits of alternative sexuality and who is willing to explore the possibility of paid sex. The urban man's appetite remains as voracious as ever, no surprises there, even if the reality is often grim, with sex being bought.

What is elevating though is that the urban Indian bedroom may not necessarily be an arena of com-

bat between the sexes. Women may not want to confess to their deepest fantasies (a majority coyly says their greatest fantasy lover is their partner, not a celebrity) but as the silent shattering of other myths shows, what is beneath the sheets is no longer what lies beneath. Women are standing up for their pleasures, role-playing, even trying sex with eunuchs. Fun, fearless and fierce. Will sex emerge as therapy for a modern society with its attendant anxieties? Will the good Indian girl and boy, restricted as they by society in their choice of monogamous partner, have greater latitude with their sleeping partner? As the silent pushing of the sexual envelop shows, the missionary position stands, but just about.

For past surveys, interactive graphics visit:
www.indiatoday.in/sexsurvey08

